MOTH

Factory Presets — v0.2.0

12 starting points for exploration

These presets are starting points, not destinations. Every combination of parameters is a sweetspot. Dial in a preset, then explore from there. Remember that your instance's DNA adds its own subtle character on top of these values — no two Moths will sound identical even with the same preset.

To use a preset, set each slider to the value shown. Once dialled in, save as a DAW preset (Ableton: click the floppy disk icon in the title bar; Reaper: Presets menu → Save preset).

Fingerpicked Guitar

Warm nylon-string fingerpick. The default starting point — soft attack, woody body, gentle tape warmth.

Morph	0	Tilt	0.15	Stochastic	0.05
Damping	0.7	Brightness	0.5	Dispersion	0
Position	0.3	Geometry	0.38	Body Bright	0.45
Body Damp	0.35	Body Size	0.4	Drive	1.5
Tape	0.4	Tube	0	Warmth	0.3
Tone	0.5	Room	0.3	Reverb Mix	0.2
Bleed	0.05	Body Mix	0.85	Master (dB)	-6

Steel String Pick

Bright, snappy steel-string with a hard plectrum. Crisp attack, slight tape compression to tame transients.

Morph	0.2	Tilt	0.75	Stochastic	0.03
Damping	0.65	Brightness	0.7	Dispersion	0.02
Position	0.25	Geometry	0.4	Body Bright	0.55
Body Damp	0.3	Body Size	0.45	Drive	1.8
Tape	0.5	Tube	0	Warmth	0.25
Tone	0.55	Room	0.25	Reverb Mix	0.15
Bleed	0.08	Body Mix	0.8	Master (dB)	-6

Bowed Cello

Rich, sustained bowing on a large stringed body. Tube warmth adds even-harmonic fullness. Play with aftertouch for bow pressure dynamics.

Morph	0.4	Tilt	0.3	Stochastic	0.02
Damping	0.82	Brightness	0.45	Dispersion	0.01
Position	0.45	Geometry	0.33	Body Bright	0.42
Body Damp	0.38	Body Size	0.65	Drive	1.4
Tape	0	Tube	0.45	Warmth	0.35
Tone	0.5	Room	0.4	Reverb Mix	0.25
Bleed	0.03	Body Mix	0.88	Master (dB)	-6

Eastern Bowed String

A brighter, more nasal bowed tone inspired by erhu and kamancheh. Position near the bridge, violin body, touch of dispersion for metallic shimmer.

Morph	0.4	Tilt	0.45	Stochastic	0.04
Damping	0.75	Brightness	0.6	Dispersion	0.08
Position	0.18	Geometry	0.32	Body Bright	0.58
Body Damp	0.28	Body Size	0.3	Drive	1.3
Tape	0	Tube	0.3	Warmth	0.2
Tone	0.55	Room	0.35	Reverb Mix	0.2
Bleed	0.04	Body Mix	0.82	Master (dB)	-5

Breathy Clarinet

Sustained reed tone with gentle breath turbulence. Tube body provides the warm bore resonance of a real clarinet.

Morph	0.6	Tilt	0.35	Stochastic	0.08
Damping	0.78	Brightness	0.4	Dispersion	0
Position	0.4	Geometry	0.1	Body Bright	0.38
Body Damp	0.3	Body Size	0.5	Drive	1.2
Tape	0	Tube	0.25	Warmth	0.3
Tone	0.5	Room	0.3	Reverb Mix	0.18
Bleed	0.02	Body Mix	0.9	Master (dB)	-6

Electric Piano

Tine-like pluck with slight piano stiffness in the partials. Boxy body, tube saturation for the classic Rhodes-adjacent warmth.

Morph	0.05	Tilt	0.55	Stochastic	0
Damping	0.6	Brightness	0.55	Dispersion	0.12
Position	0.35	Geometry	0.48	Body Bright	0.5
Body Damp	0.4	Body Size	0.38	Drive	1.6
Tape	0.2	Tube	0.4	Warmth	0.25
Tone	0.55	Room	0.2	Reverb Mix	0.12
Bleed	0.06	Body Mix	0.75	Master (dB)	-6

Temple Bell

Bright metallic strike with widely spread inharmonic modes. Long ring, shimmering body, cathedral reverb.

Morph	0.1	Tilt	0.7	Stochastic	0
Damping	0.9	Brightness	0.6	Dispersion	0.55
Position	0.4	Geometry	0.88	Body Bright	0.65
Body Damp	0.82	Body Size	0.3	Drive	1.5
Tape	0	Tube	0	Warmth	0.15
Tone	0.6	Room	0.8	Reverb Mix	0.35
Bleed	0.02	Body Mix	0.7	Master (dB)	-8

Singing Bowl

Rim-friction on a resonant metal bowl. Slow, meditative sustain with evolving harmonics. Deep reverb.

Morph	0.45	Tilt	0.22	Stochastic	0.01
Damping	0.92	Brightness	0.45	Dispersion	0.35
Position	0.5	Geometry	0.8	Body Bright	0.5
Body Damp	0.78	Body Size	0.35	Drive	1.2
Tape	0.15	Tube	0	Warmth	0.4
Tone	0.45	Room	0.7	Reverb Mix	0.4
Bleed	0.01	Body Mix	0.9	Master (dB)	-8

Tape-Warm Pad

E-bow sustain through a large guitar body, heavy tape saturation, and generous reverb. Lush, evolving ambient texture. Hold long notes.

Morph	0.8	Tilt	0.2	Stochastic	0
Damping	0.95	Brightness	0.35	Dispersion	0.03
Position	0.5	Geometry	0.36	Body Bright	0.35
Body Damp	0.45	Body Size	0.6	Drive	2.2
Tape	0.75	Tube	0	Warmth	0.55
Tone	0.4	Room	0.55	Reverb Mix	0.3
Bleed	0.02	Body Mix	0.92	Master (dB)	-8

Rain on Metal

32-point granular cloud striking a metal plate. Stochastic, textural, percussive. Wonderful layered with other sounds.

Morph	1	Tilt	0.55	Stochastic	0.8
Damping	0.5	Brightness	0.55	Dispersion	0.3
Position	0.5	Geometry	0.72	Body Bright	0.65
Body Damp	0.6	Body Size	0.4	Drive	1.8
Tape	0.35	Tube	0	Warmth	0.2
Tone	0.5	Room	0.45	Reverb Mix	0.22
Bleed	0.12	Body Mix	0.65	Master (dB)	-6

Ambient Drone

E-bow into a massive hollow tube. Near-infinite sustain, heavy warmth, cathedral space. The instrument breathes. One note is enough.

Morph	0.8	Tilt	0.15	Stochastic	0.02
Damping	0.98	Brightness	0.3	Dispersion	0
Position	0.5	Geometry	0.08	Body Bright	0.3
Body Damp	0.4	Body Size	0.8	Drive	2.5
Tape	0.6	Tube	0	Warmth	0.7
Tone	0.35	Room	0.9	Reverb Mix	0.4
Bleed	0	Body Mix	0.95	Master (dB)	-10

Muted Kalimba

Short, percussive pluck with moderate dispersion for metallic tine character. Small box body, dry, punchy.

Morph	0	Tilt	0.5	Stochastic	0
Damping	0.35	Brightness	0.55	Dispersion	0.2
Position	0.3	Geometry	0.5	Body Bright	0.5
Body Damp	0.25	Body Size	0.28	Drive	1.3
Tape	0	Tube	0	Warmth	0.1
Tone	0.6	Room	0.05	Reverb Mix	0.05
Bleed	0.1	Body Mix	0.7	Master (dB)	-5

Quick reference

Use this table to quickly identify which preset to start from for a given sound goal.

Preset	Character	Best for
Fingerpicked Guitar	Warm nylon-string fingerpick	Folk, singer-songwriter, gentle melodic lines
Steel String Pick	Bright, snappy steel-string with a hard plectrum	Bright acoustic parts, arpeggios, country
Bowed Cello	Rich, sustained bowing on a large stringed body	Orchestral, cinematic, emotional sustained lines
Eastern Bowed String	A brighter, more nasal bowed tone inspired by erhu and kamancheh	World music, modal melodies, microtonal exploration
Breathy Clarinet	Sustained reed tone with gentle breath turbulence	Jazz, chamber music, expressive legato
Electric Piano	Tine-like pluck with slight piano stiffness in the partials	Neo-soul, lo-fi, chord pads
Temple Bell	Bright metallic strike with widely spread inharmonic modes	Meditation, ambient transitions, sound design
Singing Bowl	Rim-friction on a resonant metal bowl	Meditation, drone foundation, healing
Tape-Warm Pad	E-bow sustain through a large guitar body, heavy tape saturation, and generous reverb	Ambient, film score, atmospheric backgrounds
Rain on Metal	32-point granular cloud striking a metal plate	Textural layers, percussive beds, sound design
Ambient Drone	E-bow into a massive hollow tube	Deep ambient, meditation, generative music
Muted Kalimba	Short, percussive pluck with moderate dispersion for metallic tine character	Percussive melodic lines, lo-fi beats, plucked textures

Every combination is a sweetspot. Explore freely.